

Grove

App User Manual

Tasks, friends, study rooms, streaks, and steady progress



Welcome to your study grove!

Grove brings tasks, friends, rooms, profile information, and streak-based tree growth into one calm workspace. This manual is written so that a new user or evaluator can create an account, test every major workflow, recognize the expected result, and troubleshoot common issues without assistance.

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Rubric Coverage at a Glance

Required item	Where it appears in this manual
Project overview and intended users	Section 2
Prototype URL	Section 3
Recommended device and browser	Section 3
Account creation	Section 4
Step-by-step use of every major feature	Sections 5–12
Expected results for each workflow	Blue “Expected result” boxes throughout
Known limitations / ongoing implementations	Section 13
Troubleshooting instructions	Section 14
Independent evaluation checklist	Section 15

Project Overview and Intended Users

What Grove is

Grove is a productivity and social study application. It helps users organize tasks, connect with friends, join or create focused study rooms, view profile information, and turn completed work into visible streak and tree progress.

Who should use it

- **Students** who want a calmer way to manage small academic tasks and focused study sessions.
- **Study partners and classmates** who want to find one another, exchange friend requests, and work in shared rooms.
- **Course staff or evaluators** who need to test the complete prototype from account creation through feature verification.
- **The Grove development team** when checking whether a feature is discoverable, understandable, and connected to the rest of the design.

Primary value proposition: Grove encourages steady, visible progress. A user can begin with one small task, complete it, and see that action reflected in the broader study experience.



Access and Evaluation Setup

Prototype URL

Deployed prototype	[https://grove-frontend-5eo5.onrender.com/]
Local development	http://localhost:5173

Recommended device and browser

- **Recommended device:** laptop or desktop computer with a screen width of at least 1280 pixels.
- **Recommended browsers:** the current stable version of Google Chrome or Microsoft Edge.
- **Also expected to work:** a current version of Firefox or Safari, although the team should verify the final deployment before submission.
- **Required browser features:** JavaScript, cookies, and site storage must be enabled. Allow popups for Grove when opening the manual in a new tab.
- **Internet connection:** required for the deployed prototype and any backend, authentication, or database requests.

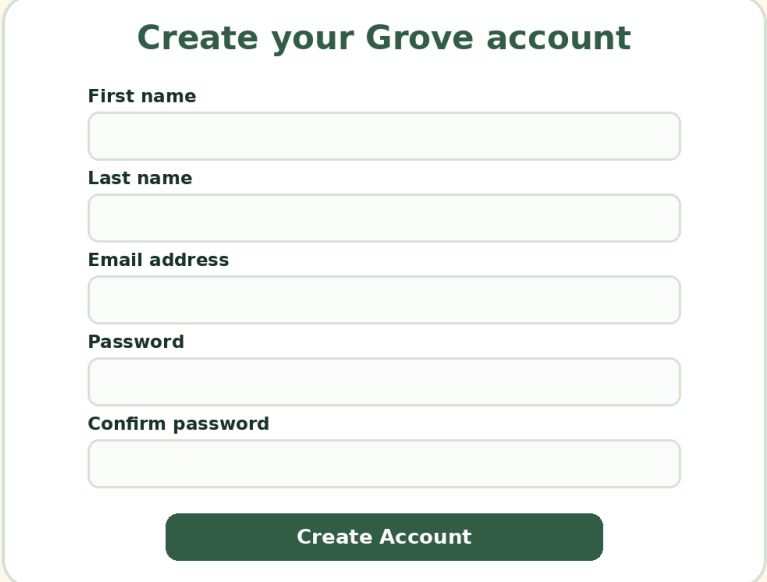
Evaluation preparation

1. Open the prototype in a private or incognito browser window so an old session does not affect the test.
2. Keep this manual open in a second tab.
3. Create a new account, or use a test account supplied by the team.
4. For friend workflows, use a second account in another browser profile or ask a teammate to sign in separately.
5. Complete the checklist in Section 15 and record any behavior that differs from the expected results.

Expected result

The Grove login or sign-up screen loads without a browser error. The evaluator can continue without needing access to the source code.

Account Creation and Login



Create your Grove account

First name

Last name

Email address

Password

Confirm password

Create Account

Illustrated guide - use the labels in the current interface.

Illustrated guide to the account-creation fields. Labels may shift slightly as the interface evolves.

Create a new account

1. Open the deployed prototype or the local development URL.
2. Select **Sign Up** or **Create Account**.
3. Enter your first name, last name, email address, and password.
4. Re-enter the password when the confirmation field is present.
5. Submit the form.
6. If Grove requests email confirmation, open the confirmation message and follow its link before logging in.

Expected result

The account is created successfully. After any required email confirmation, the user can log in and reach the Home dashboard.

Log in

1. Return to the login page.
2. Enter the account email and password.
3. Select **Log In**.

4. Wait for the Home dashboard to load.

 Expected result

The user reaches Home. On a first successful login, Grove may display a short guided popup tour over the dashboard.

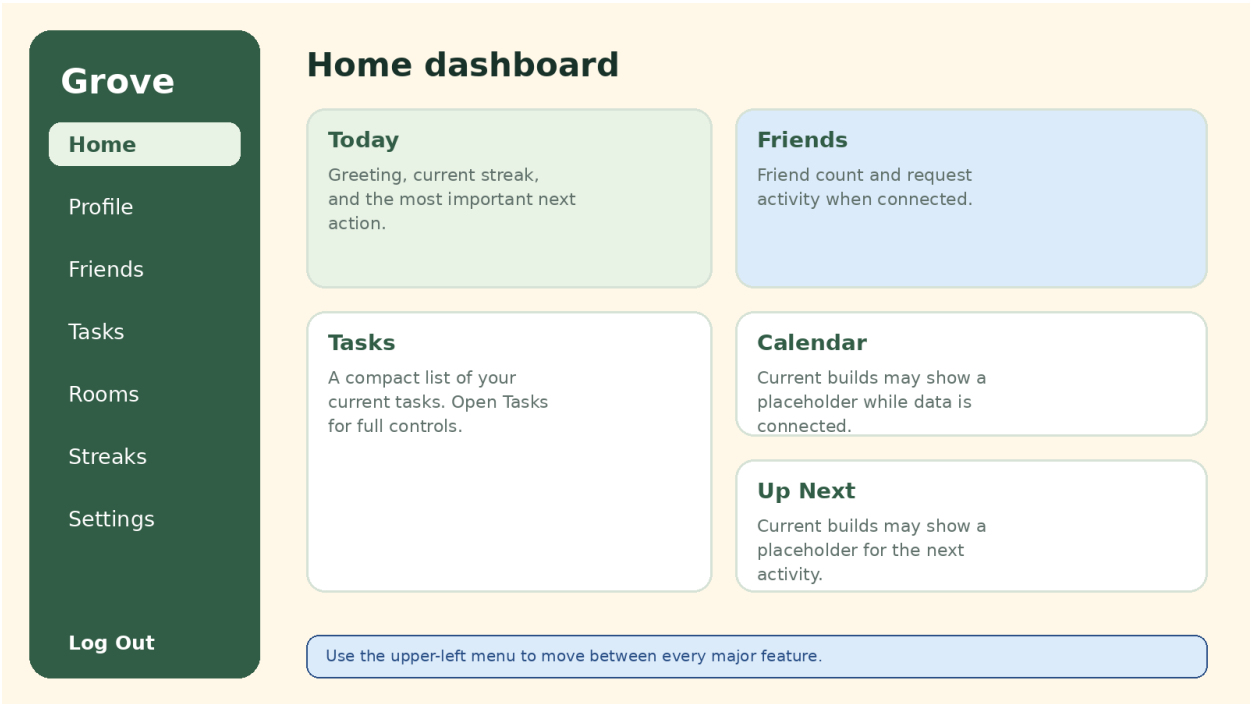
Log out

Open the navigation menu and select **Log Out** near the bottom.

 Expected result

The current session ends and the app returns to its authentication flow. Protected pages should no longer be accessible without signing in again.

Navigation and Home Dashboard



Annotated dashboard guide showing the major navigation destinations and summary cards.

Navigation map

Home	Overview of streak, friends, calendar area, upcoming activity, and tasks.
Profile	Avatar, banner, name, bio, streak, and public profile information.
Friends	Search for users, send requests, accept or decline requests, and remove friends.
Tasks	Add, complete, reopen, and delete tasks.
Rooms	Browse study rooms or create one with a map, timer, music, chat, and invited friends.
Streaks	View points, daily streak, tree level, next growth milestone, and the next task to complete.
Settings	Open this manual or replay the Home tutorial.

Use the Home dashboard

1. After login, read the greeting and confirm that the correct first name appears when profile data is available.
2. Review the streak and friends summary cards.
3. Review the calendar and Up Next areas. These may still show placeholders in the current implementation.

4. Review the Home-page task summary.
5. Open the upper-left navigation menu to move to a full feature page.

 Expected result

The dashboard provides a readable overview, the menu opens, and every implemented navigation item leads to its matching page rather than redirecting unexpectedly.

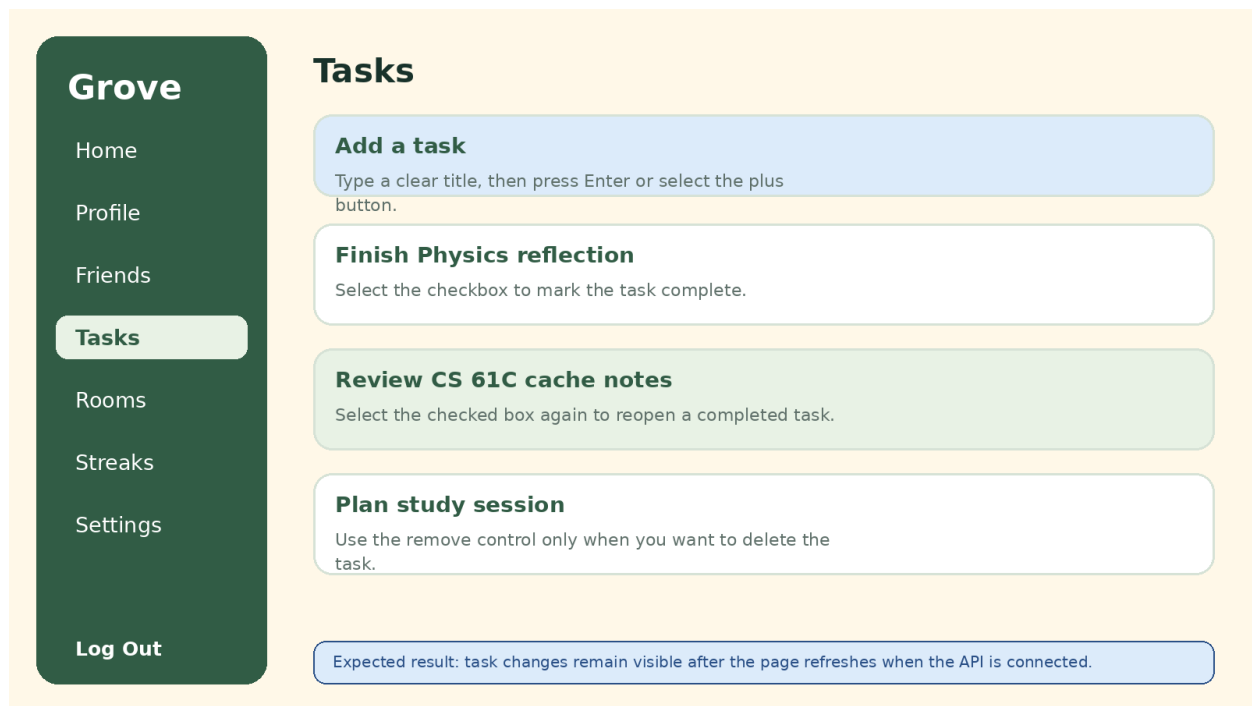
Use or replay the popup tour

When the tutorial is queued after login, use **Next** and **Back** to move through the highlighted Home-page features. Close the tour at any time, or replay it later from Settings.

 Expected result

Each tutorial step highlights the intended Home-page feature. Finishing or closing the tour leaves the user on a usable Home dashboard.

✓ Tasks



Annotated guide to adding, completing, reopening, and removing tasks.

Add a task

1. Open **Tasks** from the navigation menu.
2. Select the “Add a task” field.
3. Enter a short, specific title such as “Finish the Physics 89 reflection.”
4. Press **Enter** or select the plus button.

✓ Expected result

The new task appears in the task list. When the backend is connected, it should remain visible after refreshing the page or signing back in.

Complete or reopen a task

1. Select the empty square checkbox beside an unfinished task.
2. Confirm that the task changes to its completed appearance.
3. Select the checked box again when you need to reopen the task.

 Expected result

The task completion state changes immediately. Completing a task contributes to points and streak-related progress in the current app design.

Delete a task

Select the remove control beside a task that is no longer needed, then confirm the action if the interface requests confirmation.

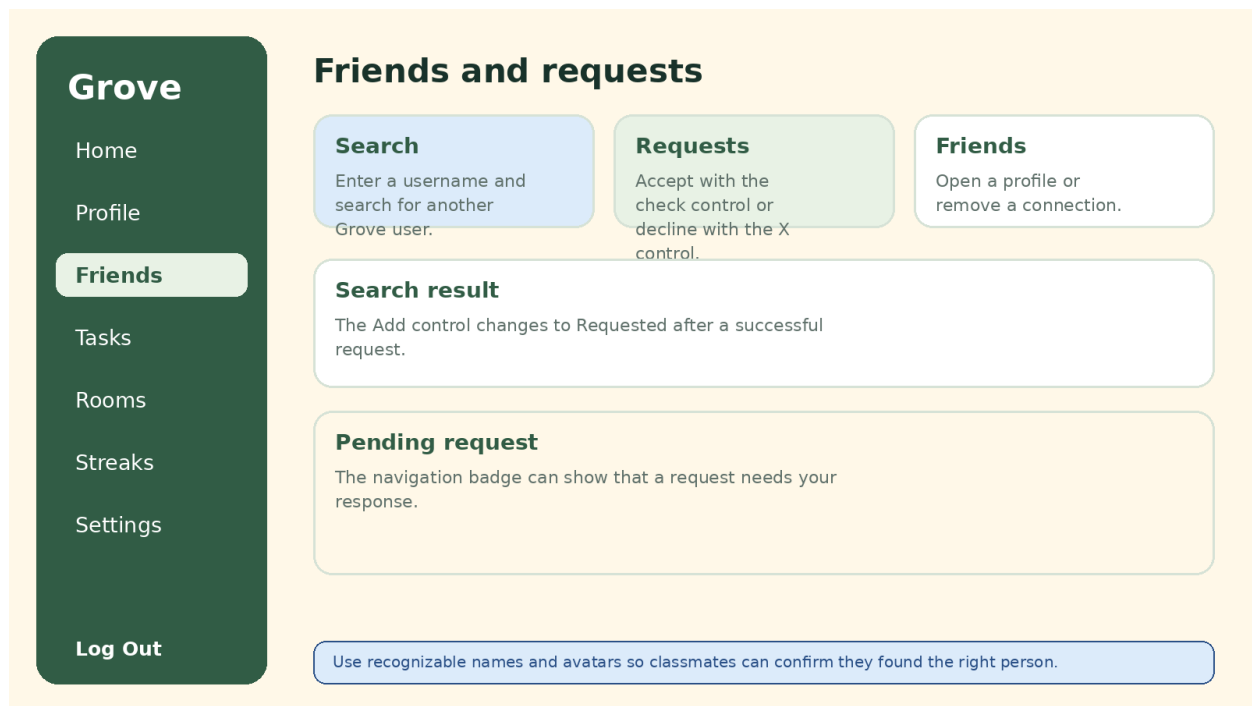
 Expected result

The task disappears from the active list and does not return after a successful refresh.

 Write tasks that are easy to start

Use a concrete action such as “Review cache miss examples” instead of a broad label such as “Do school.”

Friends



Annotated guide to user search, requests, and the friends list.

Search for another user

1. Open **Friends**.
2. Open the search area or search tab.
3. Enter a username.
4. Select **Search**.
5. Select a result to open that user's profile when needed.

Expected result

Matching users appear. Each matching result links to the associated Grove profile.

Send a friend request

Select **Add** next to the intended search result.

Expected result

The control changes to **Requested** after a successful request, preventing an accidental duplicate request.

Accept or decline a request

1. Open the **Requests** tab.
2. Select the check control to accept, or the X control to decline.

Expected result

An accepted user moves into the Friends list. A declined request is removed from the pending list. The navigation badge should update when no pending requests remain.

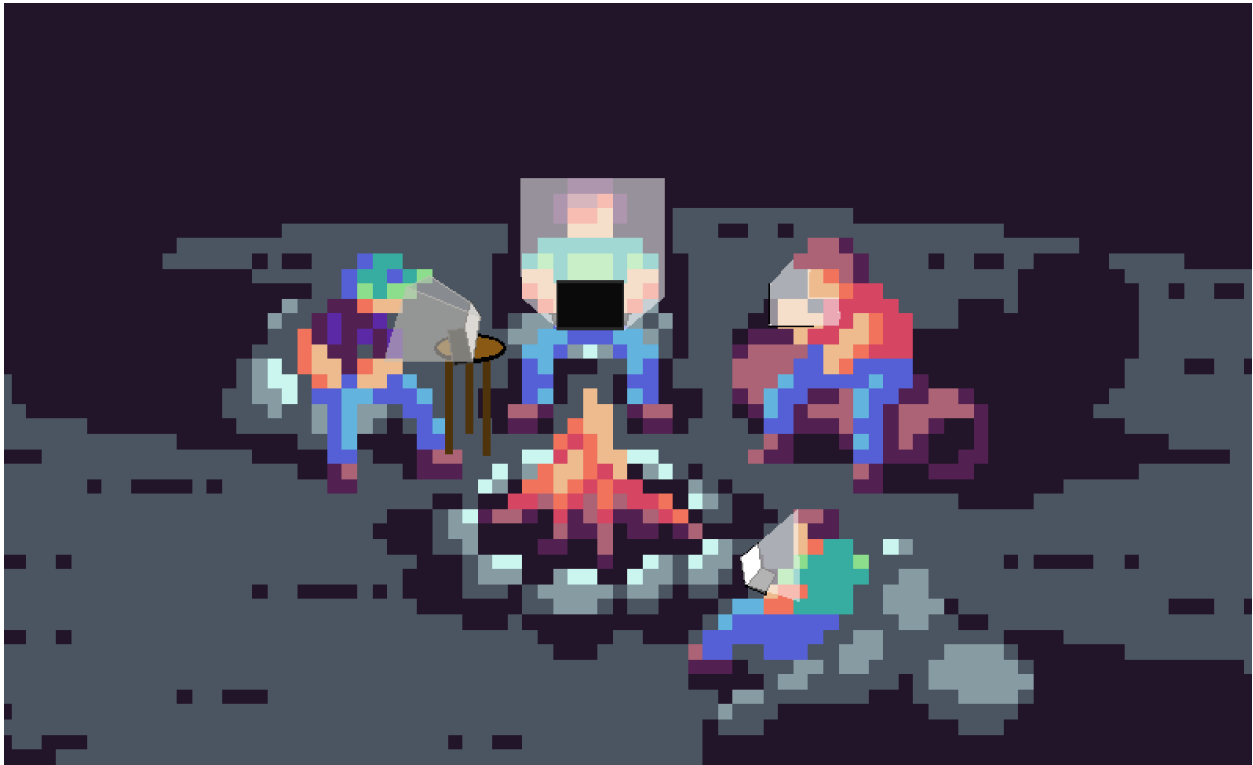
Remove a friend

Open the **Friends** tab and select **Remove** beside the person you want to disconnect from.

Expected result

The person no longer appears in the Friends list. The relationship change should also be reflected for the other account when both clients refresh.

Study Rooms



Annotated study-room guide. The current prototype may use different sample room names or visual maps.

Join a room

1. Open **Rooms**.
2. Review the room cards in the lobby.
3. Select a room card. Each card shows the room name and the number of people studying.
4. Wait for the selected room view to open.

Expected result

The room view opens with the selected room's information, focus timer, and any enabled music or chat controls.

Create a room

1. Select the create-room control in the lobby.
2. Enter a room name.
3. Choose a visual setting or map when the option is available.
4. Set the focus timer length.

5. Search for friends and select any users to invite.
6. Choose whether music and chat should be enabled.
7. Submit the room form.

 Expected result

The new room opens or appears in the lobby with the chosen name and settings. Invited friends can identify the session from the room information.

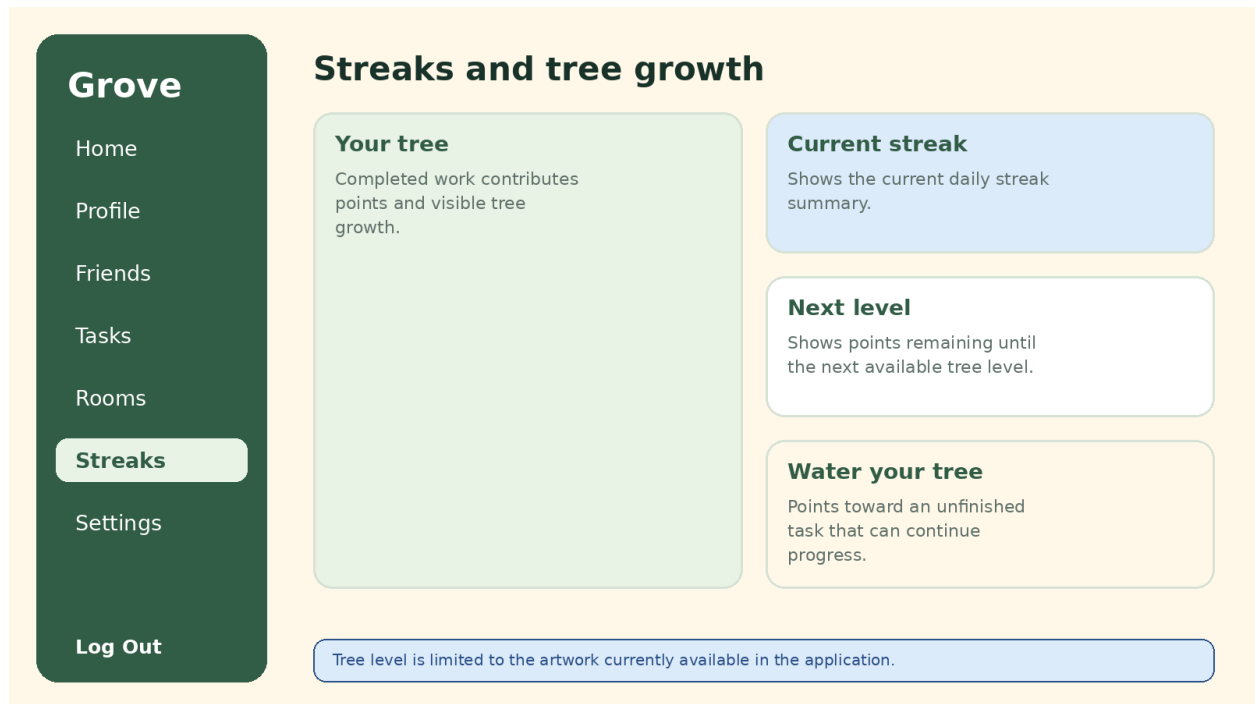
Use the focus controls

Inside a room, start or pause the timer, reset it when needed, and toggle room music when the room supports music. Chat controls appear only when chat is enabled.

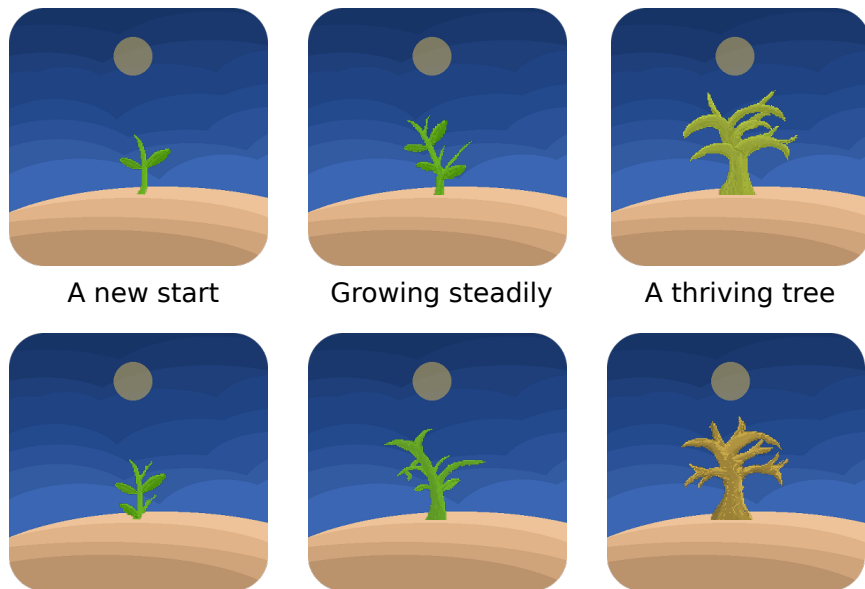
 Expected result

The timer responds to start, pause, and reset actions. Disabled room features do not appear as active controls.

🔥 Streaks and Tree Growth



Annotated guide to the streak summary, tree level, next milestone, and suggested task.



Review progress

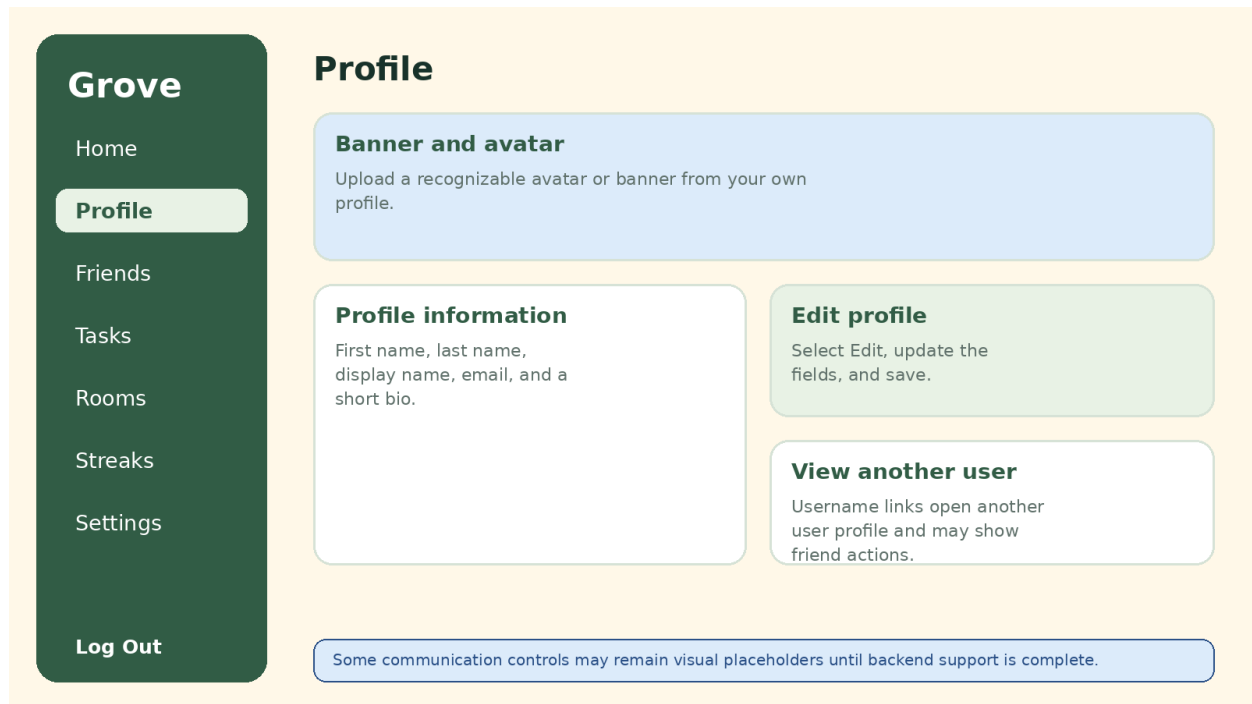
1. Open **Streaks**.

2. Review the total points and current daily streak.
3. Review the displayed tree level.
4. Read the progress card to see how many points remain before the next level.
5. Use the “Water your tree” card to identify an unfinished task.

 Expected result

The page shows the user’s current points, streak, available tree art, and next milestone. At the maximum available level, the page shows a fully grown state rather than an unavailable image.

Profile



Annotated guide to profile information, editing, and another user's profile.

Edit your own profile

1. Open **Profile**.
2. Select the edit control.
3. Update the available fields, which may include first name, last name, display name, email, and bio.
4. Upload a new avatar or banner image when desired.
5. Save the changes.

Expected result

The profile returns to its normal view and displays the saved information. A successful avatar or banner upload appears on the user's own profile.

View another user

Select a username from search results, friend lists, or other username-based links.

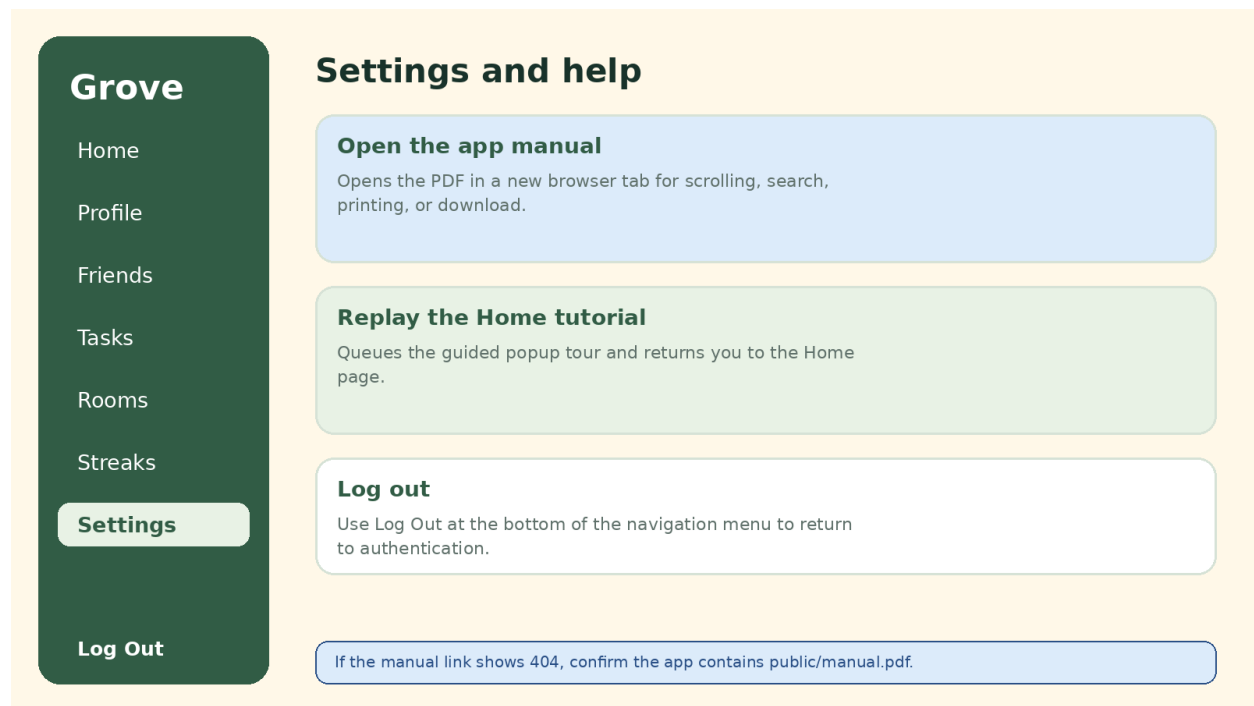
**Expected result**

The other user's profile opens. Depending on relationship status and backend support, Grove may show an action such as adding the user as a friend.

**Keep it recognizable**

A clear display name, a short bio, and a recognizable avatar help classmates confirm that they found the correct person.

Settings and Help



Annotated guide to the manual, tutorial replay, and logout actions.

Open the app manual

1. Open **Settings**.
2. Select **Open the app manual**.
3. Allow a new browser tab if the browser blocks popups.

Expected result

The PDF opens in a new tab. The user can scroll continuously, use document search, print, or download the manual.

Replay the Home tutorial

Select **Replay the Home tutorial**.

Expected result

Grove returns to Home and queues the guided dashboard popups so the user can review the feature tour again.

Known Limitations and Ongoing Implementations

The following items are documented limitations in the current source rather than user mistakes:

Area	Current limitation or ongoing work
Home calendar	The calendar card may still display a placeholder until its data source is connected.
Home Up Next	The next-activity card may display a placeholder while the feature is being connected.
Rooms and friends data	A fresh database may include sample rooms or sample friends so the interface is not empty. Production data should replace these placeholders.
Profile communication	Some actions on another user's profile may remain visual placeholders depending on backend support.
Room chat and music	These controls appear only when enabled for the room, and their final behavior depends on backend integration.
Tree artwork	The displayed level is limited to the tree art currently available. The interface should cap the level rather than request a missing asset.
Backend dependency	Tasks, rooms, friends, profiles, and streak data require the configured backend and API URL.
Tutorial timing	The tour is designed to start after a successful login, not after every page refresh.
Prototype URL	The deployed URL must be inserted into this manual before final submission.



How evaluators should report a limitation

Record the page, the exact action taken, the expected result from this manual, the actual result, and whether the issue also occurs after a fresh login. This makes it easier to separate a known limitation from a new defect.

Troubleshooting

The tutorial does not appear

The tour starts immediately after a successful login rather than after every refresh. Use **Settings** → **Replay the Home tutorial** to run it again.

The PDF button opens nothing or shows 404

Confirm that the frontend project contains:

```
public/manual.pdf
```

Vite serves files from `public` at the site root, so the Settings link should point to `/manual.pdf` or use `import.meta.env.BASE_URL`.

Settings returns to Home

Check the routing configuration. The Settings route must render the Settings page instead of redirecting:

```
<Route path="/settings" element={<Settings />} />
```

Invalid Refresh Token

An old Supabase session may remain in browser storage. Clear the site's stored data, reload, and log in again. This issue is separate from the tutorial and PDF features.

Tasks, rooms, friends, profiles, or streaks fail to load

1. Confirm that the backend is running.
2. Confirm that `VITE_API_URL` points to the correct API.
3. Check that the user is still logged in.
4. Refresh the page once.
5. Open the browser developer console and record the first relevant request or error for the development team.

A friend workflow cannot be completed

Use two different accounts in separate browser profiles. A single account cannot both send and accept the same request.

A newly created item disappears after refresh

The interface may have updated locally even though the backend request failed. Confirm the backend connection, repeat the action once, and look for an error message or failed network request.

The interface looks compressed or controls overlap

Use the recommended desktop browser, reset browser zoom to 100%, and enlarge the window. Record the screen width if the issue continues.



Before submitting or deploying

Test the app in a fresh private browser session: sign up, log in, finish the tutorial, visit every major page, add and complete a task, test a friend request with a second account, enter or create a room, open Settings, open the PDF, replay the tutorial, and confirm the browser back button behaves normally.

Independent Evaluation Checklist

- ✓ The deployed prototype URL in Section 3 is real and clickable.
- ✓ I can create an account, complete any required email confirmation, and log in.
- ✓ I can reach Home and use the navigation menu without assistance.
- ✓ Every implemented page has a matching route and does not unexpectedly redirect.
- ✓ I can add, complete, reopen, and delete a task.
- ✓ I can search for users, send a request, and respond from a second account.
- ✓ I can open another user's profile.
- ✓ I can enter an available study room.
- ✓ I can create a room with a name, timer, invitations, and selected options.
- ✓ I can start, pause, and reset the room timer.
- ✓ I can view points, current streak, tree level, and next growth milestone.
- ✓ I can edit my profile and save the changes.
- ✓ Settings opens `/manual.pdf` in a new tab.
- ✓ Settings can replay the Home tutorial.
- ✓ I reviewed the known limitations and did not mistake them for undocumented behavior.
- ✓ I can complete the full test without asking the development team how to find a feature.

You are ready to grow.

